

6.4.1 How It Works

Spammers these days are using more and more complex methods to hide their identities and to send e-mails from a host of wholly random e-mail addresses. Using e-mail clients to disguise the origins of e-mails has become somewhat naïve as users and e-mail hosts are becoming quick to spot fakes.

Most spammers these days use worms to do their dirty work. After infecting a host computer, the worm searches the address book of the e-mail client that the host is using. Then, it uses those addresses in the “From” field of the e-mail and sends the spam to the rest of the users in the address book. Some of the smarter worms have random word generators and inbuilt word lists that are used to change the address of the sender.

6.4.2 Telling A spoof

There are some reasonably simple ways one can tell whether an e-mail is a spoof or has been sent from a genuine e-mail address.

- Even if the name of the sender appears to be legitimate, check



Citibank doesn't have such a cryptic mail server